

enhance predictive capabilities while aiming for advancements in predicting ventilator performance,” he adds.

“We stand out as the only ventilator company globally with an OTA feature to roll out software upgrades to end customers without needing on-site personnel, a capability lacking in our competitors. This does not require a constant connection. Even though it is possible to control remotely, we intentionally avoid making everything online, maintaining a level of control. We have implemented measures to prevent certain commands from being sent to specific hardware boards for digital security and hardware safety,” Kurele says.

The startup uses an HIPAA-compliant platform, HorizonView, to meet medical-grade international compliance standards.

The latest product, V370i, is a compressor-based ventilator with an integrated humidifier that addresses moisture needs, for instance when a patient receives a dry air-oxygen mixture. “In India, people often forget alarms from a separate humidifier, but our ventilator can control and monitor the humidifier, eliminating the need for continuous supervision, and addresses issues such as empty water, ensuring the patient receives proper humid air, etc,” explains Kurele.

Kurele refrains from revealing the product’s price but vouches for its affordability. “Since we source raw



(L to R) Co-founders: Nikhil Kurele, Harshit Rathore, and Tushar Agarwal

materials instead of pre-assembled solutions, we in-house design and integrate a digital platform that allows remote access to patient information daily. For instance, our six-layer PCB board for the product’s internal computer is developed in-house. We get it assembled in neighbouring countries, send some components there, and then receive the assembled PCB, helping us combat supply-chain issues,” he elaborates.

With nine patents in bag and 14 in the application stage, the company aims to achieve a revenue of ₹300-350 million in FY25. “We are set to close at around ₹120 million in this financial year, an increase from the approximately ₹100 million achieved last year,” states Kurele.

Noccarc is currently relying on the automotive manufacturing ecosystem in Pune to manufacture its components. The startup produces 20-25 ventilators per month, including both models. “Facilities focused on electronics for automobiles are well-equipped for manufacturing

medical electronics components. However, these facilities are reluctant to engage with us as vendors due to the significant difference in production volumes between automotive and medical devices,” he reveals.

Elaborating on the startup’s revenue model, Kurele says, “We sell our products to distributors who, in turn, sell to hospitals. The distributor looks into lead generation and manages the credit requirement of the end customer. We are also experimenting with new revenue models such as leasing and subscription-based software in the future.”

Post-Covid-19, with buyers focused on clinical accuracy, comprehensive features and affordability, Kurele envisions capitalising on the trend while maintaining competitive pricing with industry leaders. The startup aims to scale sales from 20-25 units to 100-120 units within the next two years by lowering the total cost of ownership through innovations and using generic consumables.

—Yashasvini Razdan

2 ‘COUNTER’-ING THE AIR-BORNE THREAT WITH MEGH ROBOTICS

Incubated at IIT Patna, Megh Robotics designs and manufactures indigenous counter-drone systems for police departments and other government security forces

With a zeal to become a manufacturer and job provider, Sobhan Chakraborty, a techpreneur, registered a company called Scraptechies Solutions Pvt Ltd in 2018 after graduating. After numerous hits and

misses, Chakraborty finally pivoted to designing counter-drone systems for the defence and security industry in 2021. Within two years, his efforts bore fruit, and Chakraborty’s Megh Robotics recorded an overall turnover of ₹19 million in its second